Devarim 5784

This week is פרשת דברים which is שבת חזון. Before we start, I want to just wish Dovid Bennett a מזל טוב on his birthday, and I hope you lein well.

In the הפטרה of חֲזוֹן יְשַׁעְיָהוּ is the pasuk: צִיּוֹן בְּמִשְׁפָּט תִּפָּדֶה וְשָׁבֶיהָ בִּצְדָקָה - Tziyon, which R' Chaim Kanievsky זצ"ל (*Rav Chaim Kanievsky on Chumash*. Permission granted by ArtScroll / Mesorah Publications) explains refers to the בית המקדש, will be returned to us through משפט, through justice. The בית המקדש did not do any עבירה. Therefore, it is only just that it should be restored as soon as possible. However, וְשָׁבֶיהָ - the people of ירושלים, those who are returning to her, who are human beings - have to do תשובה. That part can only happen through צדקה, with righteousness. If we do תשובה, הקדוש ברוך הוא will return the people and the בית המקדש.

R' Chaim addresses a fascinating problem. My brother, עליו השלום, always made a point of saying the ברכה in bentching בּוֹנֵה יְרוּשָׁלַיִם אָמֵן. He emphasized that it says בונה ירושלים, implying it will be rebuilt without רחמים. But we usually say: בּוֹנֵה בְרַחֲמָיו יְרוּשָׁלַיִם אָמֵן. So which is it?

In fact, it's brought down that no less than the גאון himself would leave out the word בְרַחֲמָיו and just say בּוֹנֵה יְרוּשָׁלַיִם. So how can one say that ירושלים will be rebuilt without רחמים? That's really a שאלה on the גר"א.

Rav Chaim brings many ראיות that we should say בְרַחֲמָיו. One of them is a pasuk in זכריה א׳:ט״ז: שַׁבְתִּי לִירוּשָׁלַ͏ִם בְּרַחֲמִים. Another is what we say three times a day in שמונה עשרה: וְלִירוּשָׁלַיִם עִירְךָ בְּרַחֲמִים תָּשׁוּב. We also say בְּרַחֲמִים there. And again in שמונה עשרה we say: וְתֶחֱזֶינָה עֵינֵינוּ בְּשׁוּבְךָ לְצִיּוֹן בְּרַחֲמִים. So we know that Hashem will grant us רחמים in the rebuilding of ירושלים.

So he says, based on the pasuk we just quoted, that yes, Hashem will return through רחמים. However, בונה ירושלים, to rebuild ירושלים - and that refers specifically to the בית המקדש - that will be done with משפט, because that is what is just and right, that the בית המקדש should be rebuilt with משפט.

Therefore, it behooves us to focus on both of these aspects. We have to be ישרותדיק in our entire lives, in our dealings certainly בין אדם לחברו, and even בין אדם למקום. But we also have to increase our צדקה. We have to do more in terms of תשובה, תפלה, and צדקה. We're heading into אלול, into the new year. We know that these are the three critical elements that we need in order to ensure that we'll have, אם ירצה השם, א גוט גענעבענטשט יאר. And we will, אם ירצה השם, come together for שמחות - with צדקה, with משפט, and with נחת.

https://youtu.be/yOLqURpH3E0